



Crocodile Stitch Cloche

Designed by Lianka Azulay© 2010



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Materials:

1 Skein of Uptown Baby Sport in Shell #204; 361 yards/100 grams
Yardage: Approximately 350 yds
Sizes G (4.25 mm) crochet hook
1" round button for flower (optional)
Place marker
Yarn needle



Gauge:

With G crochet hook in V-st pattern: 9 sts (3 V-sts) and 4 rows = 2"

CHECK YOUR GAUGE. Use any size hook to obtain gauge.

Finished Size:

20 - 22" head circumference

Abbreviations:

Beginning (beg)
Chain (ch)
Double Crochet (dc)
Half Double Crochet (hdc)
Repeat (rep)
Single Crochet (sc)
Slip Stitch (sl st)
Space (sp)
Stitch (st)
Yarn Over (yo)

Special Stitches Used:

Single Crochet Two Stitches Together (sc2tog) – Insert hook into stitch and draw up a loop. Insert hook into next stitch and draw up a loop. Yo, draw through all 3 loops on hook—1 st decreased

Front Post Double Crochet (fpdc) – Yo and insert hook from the front to the back around the post of the dc of previous row. Complete as for a regular dc stitch.

V-Stitch (V-st) – Work (dc 1, ch 1, dc 1) in stitch indicated.

Pattern Notes:

1. Cloche is worked in rounds beginning at lower edge.
2. In short, the “crocodile stitch” is formed by a two-row repeat: a row of V-sts followed by a row of scales (or shells). This is a fairly easy pattern to execute and fast to memorize. The only novelty about this design is **that the scales are crocheted in front of the V-sts with clusters of front post double crochets (fpdc) from top to bottom, then from bottom to top**, as opposed to working them on top of the row, like in most shell patterns.

Directions for Hat:

Ch 78, being careful not to twist chain, join with sl st in first ch to form a ring.

Rnd 1: Ch 4 (count as a dc and a ch-1 sp), dc in same stitch as beg ch,* skip 2 ch, V-st in next ch, rep from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (26 V-sts)

Row 2: Ch 3 (count as a dc), working from **top to bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 4 fpdc (see pic A), ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is upside down* (V point of V-st will be facing right; see pic B), working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc (see pic C), * skip next V-st, working from **top to bottom** work 5 fpdc around post of first dc of next V-st, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways*, working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, rep from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (13 scales)

Row 3: Sl st in first 2 sts, sl st in ch-1 sp, ch 4 (count as a dc and a ch-1), dc in same ch-1 sp, yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st (see pic D), * V-st in next ch-1 sp, yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, repeat from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (26 V-sts)

Rnd 4: Sl st in first ch-1 sp, working from **top to bottom** around post of first dc of next V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is upside down*, working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc * skip next V-st, working from **top to bottom** around post of first dc of next V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways*, working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, repeat from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (13 scales)

Rnd 5 – Rnd 22: Rep Rnd 3 and Rnd 4 for pattern, **ending on a row 4**. There will be a total of 11 rows of scales.

Rnd 23 (begins top of cloche): Ch 1, * sc in next 2 sts, sc in next ch-1 sp, sc in next 2 sts, yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a sc, rep from * around; join with sl st in top of first sc – (78 sc)

Rnd 24: * sc in next 11 sc, sc2tog, rep from * around; Do not join rounds here and throughout. Use place marker to mark beginning of rounds. – (72 sc).

Rnd 25: * sc in next 10 sc, sc2tog, rep from * around – (66 sc).

Rnd 25: * sc in next 9 sc, sc2tog, rep from * around – (60 sc).

Rnd 26: * sc in next 8 sc, sc2tog, rep from * around – (54 sc).

Rnd 27: * sc in next 7 sc, sc2tog, rep from * around – (48 sc).

Rnd 28: * sc in next 6 sc, sc2tog, rep from * around – (42 sc)

Rnd 29: * sc in next 5 sc, sc2tog, rep from * around – (36 sc)

Rnd 30: * sc in next 4 sc, sc2tog, rep from * around – (30 sc)

Rnd 31: * sc in next 3 sc, sc2tog, rep from * around – (24 sc)

Rnd 32: * sc in next 2 sc, sc2tog, rep from * around – (18 sc)

Rnd 33: * sc in next sc, sc2tog, rep from * around – (12 sc)

Last Round: Sc2tog around – (6 sc). Leaving a long tail, fasten off. Using tail, weave in through all sts of last round and gather tightly. Weave in all ends.

Directions for Croco-Flower (optional embellishment):
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Ch 7, join with sl st in first ch to form a ring.

Rnd 1: * ch 10, sl st in next ch, rep from * around, join with sl st in first ch – (7 ch-10 loops)

Rnd 2: [sc, hdc, 8 dc, ch 2, 8 dc, hdc, sc] in first ch-10 sp * [sc, hdc, 8 dc, ch 2, 8 dc, hdc, sc] in next ch-10 sp, rep from * around, join with sl st in first sc. Fasten off. – (7 petals)

Finishing:

Weave in all ends. If embellishing cloche with flower, attach the flower with a 1" button sewn through the center of the flower. You may sew Croco-Flower on a brooch setting so it is removable, and you are able to embellish other garments with it.

Photo Tutorial:

Note: Yarn weight and hook size were changed for better visualization of stitches on photos.



(Picture A) Ch 3, working from **top** to **bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 4 fpdc.



(Picture B) Turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is upside down (V point of V-st will be facing right).



(Picture C) Working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc.



(Picture C cont.) First crocodile scale completed.



(Picture D) Yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st.



(Picture D cont.) V-st completed.

